

Deep Research Blueprint for a Best-in-Class Church Website and Management Platform in Jamaica

The screenshot identifies the project as the **New Testament Church of God, Bull Bay**, and the denomination's official Jamaican website maintains a dedicated Bull Bay congregation page. The wider New Testament Church of God Jamaica network says it has 361 churches and 81 District Overseers, which creates an important long-term opportunity: the Bull Bay system can be built first as a world-class local church platform while using an architecture that could later support other congregations, districts, or even a denomination-wide deployment. ¹

My central recommendation is **not to build only a church website**. Build a unified digital church platform containing four connected products:

Public Website + Member Portal + Church Management System + Commerce Platform.

That distinction matters. Modern church-management platforms such as Planning Center, Tithe.ly, Subsplash, and Churchteams converge around people management, giving, groups, communication, events, check-in, volunteers, registrations, service planning, media, and automation. ² At the public-facing level, major digital-first churches add excellent livestreaming, sermon libraries, groups, next steps, events, prayer, service opportunities, and personalized digital engagement. ³

The best result for Bull Bay would therefore look less like a conventional brochure website and more like a **digital operating system for the church**.

What “the best church website in Jamaica” should mean

The goal should not simply be visual attractiveness. The strongest competitive advantage will come from combining an excellent visitor experience with a serious internal operating system.

Bull Bay already has some digital assets to build from. The congregation appears in the denomination's official church directory and has an existing YouTube presence with full-length sermon content. ⁴ Another NTCOG congregation in Montego Bay already offers a useful local benchmark: its site exposes service schedules, events, online giving, livestreaming, baptism and decision forms, weddings, christenings, and pastoral counseling. ⁵ Bull Bay should go substantially beyond that level by integrating those public features directly with its church database and administrative workflows.

Internationally, Elevation Church emphasizes immediate access to live experiences, sermons, groups, serving and events; it also connects sermons to discussion resources and small-group study. ⁶ Planning Center's Church Center experience similarly allows members to update profiles, give, register for events, join groups and see calendars, while its broader platform handles people, check-ins, registrations and

service planning. ⁷ Tithely combines giving, people, messaging, apps, events, websites, sermon streaming, groups and a prayer wall. ⁸

That research suggests six standards Bull Bay should aim to dominate.

Standard	What the Bull Bay platform should accomplish
Visitor experience	Someone who has never attended should understand who the church is, where it is, when services occur, what to expect, how to get directions and how to contact the church within seconds.
Spiritual engagement	Sermons, Bible studies, prayer requests, salvation/decision forms, baptism, discipleship pathways and pastoral resources should all be accessible digitally.
Community	Members should be able to join ministries and groups, register for events, volunteer, receive announcements and manage their family profile.
Operational excellence	Staff should stop maintaining disconnected spreadsheets, WhatsApp lists, paper forms and separate event/member records wherever the platform can safely replace them.
Financial stewardship	Donations, campaigns, shop purchases and software sales should be reconciled accurately while remaining distinct accounting concepts.
Digital reach	Every sermon, event, ministry and product should be structured so it can be found through Google, social media and direct sharing.

The homepage itself should be deliberately simple. The highest-priority calls to action should be **Plan Your Visit, Watch Live, Latest Sermon, Give, Prayer, Events, Join a Ministry/Group**, and **Shop**. Elevation's current site follows a similarly participation-oriented model instead of burying users in organizational information. ⁹

A particularly valuable differentiator for Jamaica would be making the site extremely good on mobile devices and slower connections. It should use optimized images, responsive video embeds, aggressive caching and minimal JavaScript on public content pages. Accessibility should target **WCAG 2.2 AA**; the W3C recommends WCAG 2.2 as the current conformance target and its criteria cover keyboard navigation, focus visibility, readable interfaces, appropriately sized targets and accessible authentication. ¹⁰

Complete feature architecture

The system should be designed by modules rather than as one enormous admin screen. This allows Bull Bay to launch an excellent core product and turn additional modules on as the ministry grows.

Public church experience

Module	Features I would include
Homepage	Hero message; next service countdown; Watch Live; latest sermon; upcoming events; pastor welcome; Plan Your Visit; ministries; giving; prayer; testimonials; location/map; social links; store highlights; emergency announcements.
Plan Your Visit	Service times; map; parking guidance; accessibility information; children's ministry instructions; dress expectations; FAQs; contact details; "I'm coming" form; optional visitor follow-up.
About	Church history; mission; vision; beliefs; denomination; pastor and leadership; Bull Bay story; community work; governance/contact information.
Ministries	Youth, women, men, children, music/worship, evangelism, missions, prayer, Sunday school/Christian education, couples/family and any Bull Bay-specific ministries.
Sermons	Sermon series, speaker, date, scripture, topic, YouTube video/audio, notes, transcript, downloads, discussion questions, related sermons and sharing.
Live Church	Current livestream embed, countdown until next broadcast, service schedule, Bible link, prayer request, salvation/decision button and giving link.
Events	Calendar and list views; recurring events; registration; ticket/payment option; capacity; waiting lists; reminders; maps; QR check-in; calendar download.
Prayer	Submit public or confidential prayer requests; option to submit anonymously; prayer-team workflow; "prayed for" status; praise reports; escalation to pastor where authorized.
Next Steps	Salvation decision, baptism, membership, baby dedication/christening, counseling, wedding requests, volunteering, small groups and ministry interest.
Community/ outreach	Community programmes, food assistance, missions, disaster-relief campaigns, volunteer opportunities and impact reports.
Giving	Tithes, offerings, missions, building fund, youth ministry, disaster relief and special campaigns, with one-time and recurring support where the payment provider permits it.
Contact	Contact forms routed to departments; physical location; phone; WhatsApp; email; Google Maps; office hours; pastoral emergency instructions.
News	Announcements, pastor letters, newsletters, weekly bulletin, church updates and denomination news.
Store	Physical products, books, shirts, conference material, music, downloadable products, church-created software and subscriptions.
Search	Search sermons, events, ministries, articles, products and resources from one interface.

This aligns closely with the capabilities that contemporary ChMS platforms consider foundational. Planning Center supports people, forms, calendar, groups, giving, registrations, check-ins and service planning; Churchteams lists members, groups, communication, giving, volunteers, registration, check-in and automation; Tithely similarly combines people, messaging, giving, events and church content. ¹¹

Sermons deserve special attention rather than functioning as simple YouTube links. Life.Church's resource model demonstrates the value of keeping a sermon together with notes, transcripts, artwork and discussion resources, while Elevation publishes sermon-specific group discussions. ¹² Bull Bay could eventually make every sermon a reusable discipleship resource.

Membership and pastoral database

The database is where this becomes materially better than a conventional Jamaican church website.

Every person should have one canonical profile, while sensitive ministries receive narrower access rather than maintaining duplicate member spreadsheets.

Capability	Recommended functionality
People	Name, photograph, phone, email, address, DOB where justified, gender if required operationally, preferred contact method, membership status, date joined and profile notes.
Households	Spouses, parents, guardians, children and other household relationships.
Membership lifecycle	Visitor → returning visitor → attendee → prospective member → member → ministry participant/leader, with historical status tracking.
Connection cards	Digital first-visit form, source/referral, service attended, requested next steps and follow-up owner.
Attendance	Service, ministry, group, Sunday school and event attendance.
Membership classes	Sessions, registration, attendance, completion and follow-up.
Baptism	Request, preparation, scheduled date, completion and certificate/document record.
Baby dedication/christening	Parent/guardian details, child details, ceremony date and assigned pastor.
Pastoral care	Restricted pastoral notes, counseling requests, hospital/home visits, bereavement support and follow-up actions.
Prayer care	Requests, privacy level, assigned prayer team, follow-up and testimony/praise report.
Groups	Ministry/small-group membership, leadership, meeting schedules, capacity and attendance.

Capability	Recommended functionality
Skills and interests	Music, media, technology, teaching, hospitality, transportation, outreach and other volunteer abilities.
Documents	Membership forms, certificates, consent documents and authorized records in private Storage buckets.
Communication preferences	Email, SMS/WhatsApp, push notifications and opt-in/opt-out state.
Engagement timeline	Registrations, group joins, serving, attendance, approved pastoral interactions, giving access where role-authorized, and communication history.

Churchteams explicitly supports connection-card responses, personal conversations and follow-up assignments in member records, including automated reminders to the person responsible for following up. ¹³ That is exactly the kind of operational model Bull Bay should adopt.

Events, groups and volunteer management

The events engine should be much more powerful than “title + date.”

Events should support multiple sessions, location, online/in-person/hybrid status, registration windows, price, maximum capacity, waiting lists, ticket types, household registration, consent/waiver requirements, volunteer roles, check-in, attendance and post-event follow-up.

Planning Center Registrations demonstrates the established church-software pattern of combining event registration, payments and participant management. ¹⁴ Planning Center Groups similarly supports group discovery, sign-ups and attendance. ¹⁵

Volunteer scheduling should support teams such as ushers, worship, musicians, media, children's ministry, parking/security, hospitality, altar workers, prayer, transportation and outreach.

Each service could have a digital run sheet:

Sunday workflow	Example
Service	Sunday Morning Worship
Worship team	Assigned singers/musicians
Media	Camera, livestream, slides, sound
Hospitality	Greeters and ushers
Children's church	Teachers/helpers
Prayer	Prayer/altar ministry
Message	Pastor, title, scripture and sermon assets

Sunday workflow	Example
Announcements	Ordered announcements
Special items	Dedication, baptism, guest speaker, communion, offering campaign
Files	Slides, audio tracks, PDFs, video clips
Status	Draft → approved → completed

Planning Center Services is specifically designed around worship-service planning and volunteer scheduling, reinforcing this as a mature church-management requirement rather than an optional extra.

16

Communications and automation

This should be one of the system's greatest productivity wins.

The church should be able to send targeted announcements to, for example, **all members, youth parents, worship team, people registered for Saturday's event, first-time visitors from the past 30 days, or volunteers scheduled this weekend** without manually creating contact lists.

Modern ChMS platforms increasingly treat targeted group messaging and automation as core functions. Subsplash describes group-specific communications for ministries and volunteer cohorts, while Churchteams includes automated communication among its main operating features. ¹⁷

Recommended automated journeys include:

Trigger	Automated sequence
First-time visitor submits card	Immediate welcome → admin follow-up task → pastoral/ministry follow-up → Plan Your Next Visit message
Salvation decision	Confirmation → pastoral assignment → discipleship resources → baptism invitation
Baptism request	Confirmation → preparation instructions → staff task → reminder → completion follow-up
New member	Welcome → ministry/group discovery → volunteering orientation
Event registration	Confirmation → reminder → same-day instructions → thank-you/follow-up
Prayer request	Confirmation → prayer-team routing → pastor escalation if confidential/high priority
Volunteer schedule	Invitation → confirmation → reminder → replacement workflow if declined
Absent member	Carefully configured pastoral-care alert after an appropriate attendance threshold

Trigger	Automated sequence
Purchase	Receipt → fulfillment → shipping/download instructions
Software purchase	Payment confirmation → license entitlement → onboarding email → download/dashboard access
Donation	Receipt → campaign allocation → donor acknowledgement subject to church policy
Birthday/anniversary	Optional messages based on consent and data-retention policy

These workflows should be transparent and editable by administrators rather than buried in code.

Admin, pastor, ministry and member workspaces

Do **not** give every staff member an “admin” account.

A high-quality system separates duties. That increases productivity while protecting confidential church information. Supabase's authorization model is particularly well suited to this approach because Supabase Auth integrates directly with PostgreSQL Row Level Security, allowing the application to enforce access rules at the database layer rather than relying solely on hidden menu items. ¹⁸

I would implement approximately these roles:

Role	Main access
Public visitor	Public content, events, sermons, store and forms.
Registered attendee/member	Own profile/household, registrations, group participation, giving receipts where applicable, orders, downloads, volunteer schedule.
Group/ministry leader	Their assigned groups, rosters, attendance, communication and basic member contact details.
Volunteer coordinator	Teams, schedules, availability and service assignments.
Content editor	Pages, sermons, events, announcements, media and SEO metadata.
Store manager	Products, inventory, orders, fulfillment, discounts and customer service.
Finance officer/treasurer	Donations, payment reconciliation, funds/campaigns, refunds where authorized and financial exports.
Church administrator	People, events, ministries, registrations, tasks, reports and operational configuration.
Pastor/pastoral-care team	Pastoral care, prayer escalations, membership health, care tasks and approved congregation analytics.

Role	Main access
Senior pastor	Pastoral functionality plus leadership dashboards and approval workflows.
System administrator	Technical configuration, users, roles and security without automatically receiving unrestricted pastoral notes.

The last point is important: **technical administration should not inherently grant pastoral confidentiality access.**

The church administrator dashboard

The administrator should open the system and immediately see actionable information rather than raw database statistics:

Today's services/events → unanswered enquiries → new visitors → pending membership actions → upcoming registrations → volunteers still needed → unfulfilled store orders → failed payments → upcoming birthdays if enabled → tasks assigned to admin → communications waiting approval.

Administrative productivity features should include global search, bulk actions, saved filters, reusable templates, CSV import/export, duplicate-person detection, configurable custom fields, mass event creation, recurring events, automatic reminders, communication history, approval queues, audit history and scheduled reports.

Planning Center supports forms and CSV imports into its people database, illustrating the importance of simple migration and data collection for church staff. ¹⁹

The pastor dashboard

The pastor should see a completely different experience:

New visitors needing follow-up → salvation decisions → baptism candidates → prayer requests requiring pastoral attention → counseling appointments → sick/bereaved members → upcoming birthdays/anniversaries if consented → recent membership changes → upcoming sermons → ministry health → overdue pastoral tasks.

The pastor's dashboard should avoid becoming a financial-surveillance screen. Giving information should follow the church's governance policy and role permissions rather than automatically being exposed to pastoral staff.

For sermon preparation, the pastor could create a sermon record containing:

Title → series → scripture → main points → notes → illustration ideas → draft transcript → resources → graphics → slides → video → final transcript → discussion questions → publication date.

After the service, that same record powers the website sermon page.

A future AI feature could allow the pastor or public to ask, “What sermons have we preached about forgiveness?” or search concepts rather than exact keywords. Supabase supports PostgreSQL `pgvector` and both semantic and hybrid search, making a permission-aware sermon/resource search practical without introducing a separate vector database. ²⁰

The member dashboard

After login, a member should see:

Welcome → next service → upcoming registrations → groups → volunteer schedule → announcements → prayer → giving history available to that member → purchases/downloads → household/profile settings.

Family records matter because parents should be able to manage children, event registrations and check-in from one household account rather than creating unrelated user records.

Planning Center's member-facing Church Center already demonstrates this pattern by allowing congregants to manage profile information, donations and schedules and to access calendars, directories, events and groups. ²¹

Leadership analytics

The executive dashboard should answer ministry questions such as:

Are visitors returning? Which ministries are growing? Which events fill fastest? How many people moved from first visit to membership? How well are volunteers being retained? Are prayer/care requests being followed up? Which sermon topics are most watched? What products sell? Which campaigns are receiving donations?

Church-management vendors increasingly surface engagement, attendance, volunteer and giving trends as church-health indicators. ²²

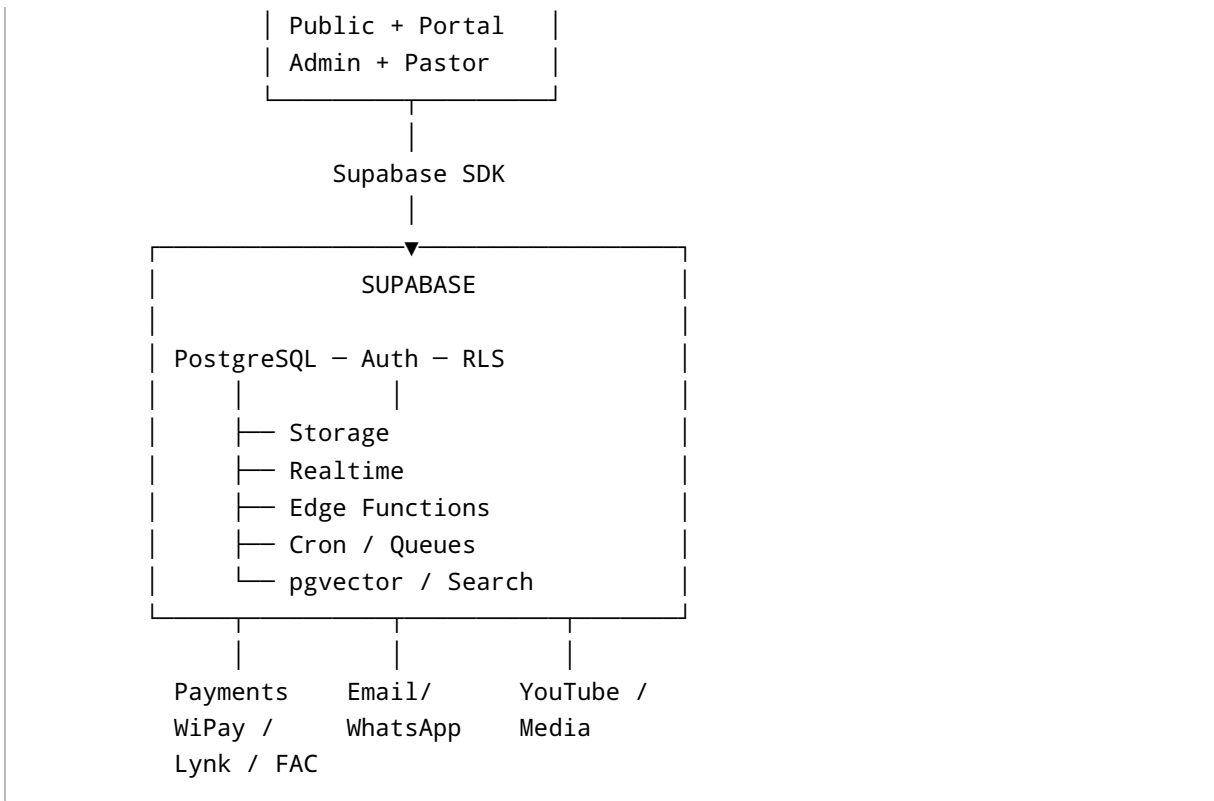
These analytics should assist ministry decisions, **not create a secret “spiritual score” for members.**

Supabase data model and application architecture

Supabase is a strong fit because each project receives a real PostgreSQL database and the platform integrates database, Auth, Storage, Realtime, Edge Functions and backups around it. ²³

I would build the application approximately as follows:





Next.js remains a particularly sensible front end because its App Router supports modern React architecture and its metadata APIs can generate search metadata, sitemaps and robots configuration directly from application data. ²⁴ Vercel is the natural deployment option for Next.js and currently provides CDN delivery, HTTPS, DDoS mitigation, deployment pipelines and web-performance tooling. ²⁵

Recommended database domains

Rather than one giant `members` table, use normalized domains.

Domain	Core tables
Identity	<code>profiles</code> , <code>user_roles</code> , <code>permissions</code> , <code>role_permissions</code> , <code>user_role_assignments</code>
People	<code>people</code> , <code>households</code> , <code>household_members</code> , <code>addresses</code> , <code>contact_methods</code> , <code>tags</code> , <code>person_tags</code>
Membership	<code>membership_status_history</code> , <code>membership_classes</code> , <code>class_enrollments</code> , <code>decisions</code> , <code>baptisms</code> , <code>dedications</code>
Care	<code>prayer_requests</code> , <code>prayer_assignments</code> , <code>pastoral_cases</code> , <code>pastoral_notes</code> , <code>care_visits</code> , <code>care_tasks</code>
Ministries	<code>ministries</code> , <code>groups</code> , <code>group_members</code> , <code>group_leaders</code> , <code>group_meetings</code> , <code>group_attendance</code>

Domain	Core tables
Services	services, service_plans, service_items, teams, team_members, volunteer_assignments
Events	events, event_sessions, registration_types, registrations, registration_attendees, checkins, waivers
Content	pages, posts, announcements, sermon_series, sermons, sermon_speakers, sermon_scriptures, media_assets
Communication	segments, message_templates, campaigns, messages, message_deliveries, communication_preferences
Tasks/workflow	tasks, task_assignments, automation_rules, automation_runs, notifications
Giving	funds, donations, donation_allocations, recurring_giving_profiles, donation_receipts
Commerce	products, product_variants, prices, inventory, carts, orders, order_items, shipments, refunds, coupons
Digital products	digital_assets, entitlements, download_events, software_licenses, license_activations, subscriptions
Payments	payment_intents, payments, payment_provider_events, refund_transactions, reconciliation_batches
Governance	audit_events, consents, privacy_requests, retention_actions, data_exports

A crucial design rule is that **authentication identity and church-person identity should not be the same table**. Someone can exist in the church database before ever creating a website login. When a member later authenticates, the system securely links the Auth user to the existing person record.

Row Level Security

Every exposed Supabase table should have explicit RLS policies. Supabase itself warns that tables in exposed schemas without appropriate RLS can be readable or writable by roles with grants, and recommends enabling RLS for exposed data. ²⁶

Examples of policy intent:

```
Member:
  read/update own profile
  read allowed household members
  read own registrations
  read own orders/download entitlements
```

Group leader:
read limited contact data for assigned group members
record attendance for assigned groups

Store manager:
manage products, inventory, orders
cannot read pastoral notes

Finance:
manage donations/payments/reconciliation
cannot read counseling notes

Pastor:
read assigned pastoral-care records
read confidential prayer requests when explicitly routed

Admin:
manage ordinary member/event data
cannot automatically read confidential pastoral notes

Confidential documents should live in **private Supabase Storage buckets**, where RLS policies can control object access. Supabase Storage supports public/private buckets, content restrictions and RLS-based access rules. ²⁷

Backend jobs and webhooks

Payment confirmations, automated emails, entitlement generation, scheduled reminders, event notifications and other sensitive logic should execute server-side rather than trusting the browser.

Supabase Edge Functions are intended for server-side TypeScript workloads and third-party webhooks; Database Webhooks can react asynchronously to inserts, updates and deletes; and Supabase supports recurring jobs through `pg_cron`. ²⁸ Queues can handle work that should retry reliably, such as email campaigns, report generation or software-license fulfillment. ²⁹

For example:

```
customer checkout
  ↓
payment provider
  ↓
signed webhook
  ↓
Supabase Edge Function
  ↓
verify provider signature
```

```

      ↓
store immutable payment event
      ↓
update payment + order
      ↓
queue fulfillment job
      ↓
physical item → warehouse/admin queue
digital product → create entitlement
software → create license/subscription
      ↓
email customer receipt

```

That flow prevents someone from altering JavaScript in the browser and pretending a purchase was successful.

Content and media strategy

Bull Bay should continue using a professional streaming platform such as YouTube for full sermon video while storing sermon metadata, transcripts, thumbnails and associated ministry resources in the church application. Bull Bay already has a YouTube channel with full-length sermons. ³⁰ This reduces the need for the church application itself to act as a high-bandwidth video CDN.

Supabase Storage is better used for photographs, PDFs, sermon notes, downloadable products, protected software packages and administrative documents. Supabase currently supports scalable object storage with a CDN and fine-grained access control. ³¹

Giving, store, software sales and Jamaica payments

This deserves a first-class architecture rather than adding a generic “Buy Now” button.

Keep donations and purchases conceptually separate

The interface can make both easy, but the data model should distinguish:

DONATION

Person → Fund/Campaign → Donation → Allocation → Payment → Receipt

PURCHASE

Customer → Order → Order Items → Payment → Fulfillment → Invoice/Receipt

That separation gives the treasurer clean records and means a J\$5,000 building-fund contribution does not become indistinguishable from a J\$5,000 merchandise purchase.

Registered Jamaican charities have ongoing governance and financial-record obligations; the Charities Authority's current guidance includes annual returns and financial statements, with its FAQ stating that prior-year annual returns and financial audits should be filed by March 31. ³² The commerce/giving architecture should therefore preserve transaction histories, fund allocations, provider transaction IDs, refunds and reconciliation records rather than only storing a successful-payment flag.

Church store

The store should support at least:

Commerce feature	Requirement
Product categories	Apparel, books, devotionals, media, event merchandise, downloads and software
Product variants	Size, colour, format, edition
Inventory	On-hand, reserved, low stock, sold out
Currency	JMD as primary; USD where payment provider/business setup supports it
Checkout	Guest checkout plus optional account
Fulfillment	Pickup at church, local delivery, shipping
Discounts	Coupon codes, event discounts, member promotions if desired
Orders	Pending, paid, processing, ready, shipped, completed, cancelled, refunded
Customer portal	Order history, receipts, downloads
Returns	Configurable return/refund workflow
Reporting	Revenue, quantity, inventory, bestselling products, refunds

Google currently supports `Product` and `Offer` structured data that can expose information such as price, availability, shipping and returns in eligible merchant experiences, making properly modeled product pages valuable beyond the site's internal store. ³³

Selling church-created software

This is where I would deliberately make the architecture future-proof.

A product should have:

```
product_type:
  physical
  digital_download
  software_license
```

```
subscription
event
```

For church-created software, the system should support:

Product page → plan/pricing → payment → customer organization/account → entitlement → license → activation → release downloads → update eligibility → invoices → renewal/cancellation.

Recommended software-related tables include:

```
software_products
software_versions
plans
customer_organizations
subscriptions
entitlements
license_keys
license_activations
release_files
download_tokens
usage_limits
webhook_endpoints
```

Never expose the downloadable software file as a permanent public Storage URL. Keep it in a private bucket and create a short-lived signed download URL only after verifying the customer's entitlement.

That same engine can eventually sell:

- Church administration software
- Sermon/media tools
- Bible-study software
- Downloadable templates
- Digital books
- Ministry training courses
- Worship resources
- Music or media packages
- SaaS subscriptions

The church therefore gets the foundation for a genuine digital-products business rather than just a merchandise page.

Payment gateway recommendation for Jamaica

This part is important because a US-centric technical design can fail in Jamaica.

Stripe's current global payments availability page does **not list Jamaica as a directly supported country for establishing ordinary Stripe payment processing**, so I would not make a Jamaican Stripe merchant account a foundational assumption. ³⁴

A better payment abstraction would be:

```
PaymentService
├── WiPayAdapter
├── LynkAdapter
└── PowertranzAdapter
```

Then Bull Bay can change commercial providers without redesigning giving, orders or accounting.

WiPay is the strongest payment provider to evaluate first. Its Jamaica offering currently advertises JMD and USD acceptance, online checkout, links, QR and local-bank settlement capability. ³⁵

Lynk is particularly interesting as a Jamaica-native secondary method. Lynk for Business says merchants can accept payments online and in person, offers a website “Pay With Lynk” option and permits transfers from LynkBiz to local bank accounts. ³⁶

Powertranz/First Atlantic Commerce is another serious option to investigate, particularly where the church establishes an appropriate bank merchant relationship. Powertranz describes itself as an online credit/debit-card payment gateway integrated with banks and shopping carts throughout the Caribbean and Central America. ³⁷

My recommended checkout would eventually look like:

```
PAY J$2,500

Credit / Debit Card
Powered by WiPay or selected acquiring gateway

Pay with Lynk

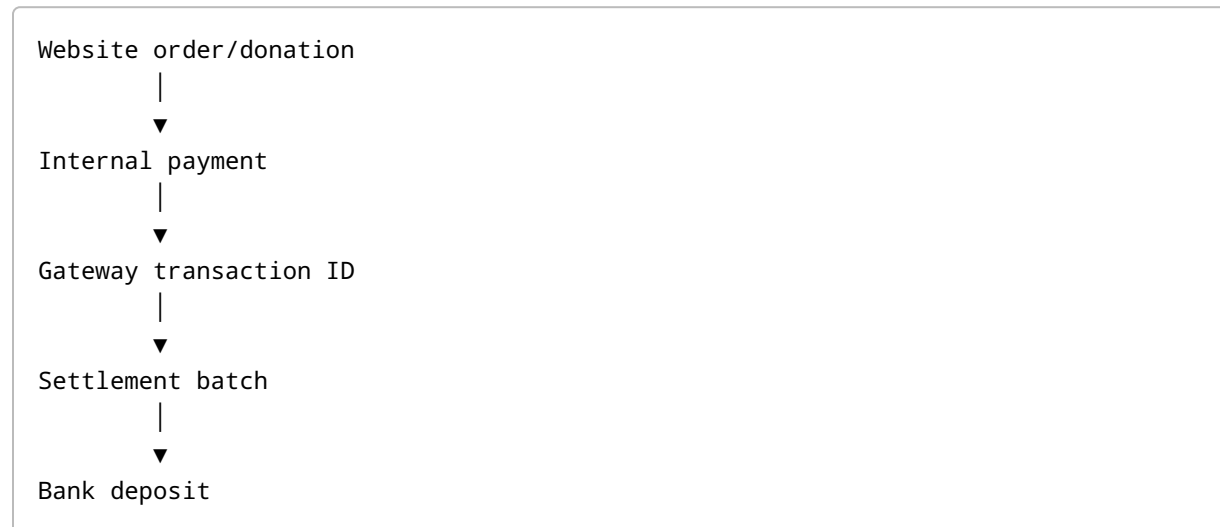
Bank / Other Approved Method

_____
Secure checkout
```

The exact gateway should be selected only after comparing current merchant onboarding, settlement currency, recurring billing support, refund API, webhook quality, chargeback procedures and transaction pricing.

Reconciliation

Every provider event must be preserved so finance staff can compare:



The treasurer should receive an exception list:

Internal total: J\$350,000
Gateway successful total: J\$350,000
Settled total: J\$342,xxx
Fees: J\$x,xxx
Unreconciled items: 0

That is more valuable operationally than merely displaying “J\$350,000 raised.”

Security, privacy, accessibility and discovery

A church database is not an ordinary marketing database. It can contain family relationships, children, prayer needs, pastoral counseling information, financial records and other highly personal material, so privacy must shape the architecture from the beginning.

Jamaica Data Protection Act

Jamaica's Office of the Information Commissioner states that the Data Protection Act applies to Jamaican data controllers and establishes requirements around lawful and transparent processing, purpose limitation, data minimization, accuracy, storage limitation, data-subject rights, technical/organizational security and cross-border transfers. The OIC also describes obligations relating to registration, Data Protection Impact Assessments and breach reporting, including a 72-hour reporting requirement after becoming aware of qualifying security breaches/contraventions. ³⁸

This has direct architectural consequences.

The church should have:

Privacy control	Implementation
Privacy notice	Clear explanation of information collected and purposes
Consent records	Timestamp, source, purpose, policy version
Communications consent	Separate email/SMS/WhatsApp preferences
Data minimization	Do not collect fields merely because the database supports them
Access request workflow	Export the person's relevant personal information
Correction workflow	Allow verified information changes
Erasure/restriction workflow	Handle valid requests according to legal/record-retention requirements
Retention schedules	Automatically flag records that should be reviewed/deleted
Security incident log	Evidence, affected subjects, response and notifications
Vendor inventory	Supabase, hosting, communications, payment and analytics processors
Data-transfer register	Record where personal information is processed

Cross-border hosting requires special attention because Jamaica's OIC expressly identifies international data transfer as one of the Act's data-protection standards. ³⁸ Before production launch, the church should have Jamaican privacy counsel or a qualified DPO assess how its use of foreign cloud providers such as Supabase/Vercel fits those obligations and what contractual/consent measures are required.

The OIC states that appointment of a DPO is required in specified situations including processing sensitive personal data or extensive processing. ³⁹ Because pastoral counseling, care or prayer submissions may include sensitive information, Bull Bay should get a specific legal determination rather than assuming an exemption.

Security controls

Require MFA for every pastor, administrator, finance user and store manager. Supabase Auth supports authenticator-app TOTP MFA and phone-based MFA flows; Supabase also integrates Auth identities with RLS. ⁴⁰

The application should be tested against OWASP ASVS, which exists specifically as a basis for verifying web-application security controls and secure development requirements. ⁴¹

At minimum:

MFA → least privilege → RLS → private Storage → webhook signature verification → rate limits → secure secrets → audit logs → automated backups → restore drills → dependency updates → security headers → CSRF/XSS/injection protection → session controls → admin-login alerts.

Supabase manages database backups on paid plans; Pro currently includes seven-day daily backup retention, while Point-in-Time Recovery is available as a paid add-on. ⁴² One important caveat is that Supabase's database backups do not include the actual objects stored through the Storage API, so protected documents and digital products need an independent Storage backup/recovery strategy. ⁴³

Audit trails

For a church-management platform, I would make auditing a product feature.

The system should record events such as:

```
admin viewed confidential request
pastor changed pastoral-case status
finance user issued refund
store manager changed product price
administrator exported member list
user role changed
member record merged
donation adjusted
event deleted
document downloaded
privacy request completed
```

The objective is not surveillance of staff; it is accountability when handling sensitive or financial information.

SEO and Google presence

The screenshot shows that the Google Business Profile is already an important digital entry point. That profile and the website should become tightly coordinated.

Google currently supports structured data for organizations, local entities, events, videos and products. Organization markup can help Google understand administrative details and branding, LocalBusiness-style structured data can communicate location/business information, Event markup can describe upcoming events and VideoObject markup can describe sermon videos. ⁴⁴ Schema.org also defines a specific

`Church` type under `PlaceOfWorship`. ⁴⁵

I would generate structured data approximately like this:

```
Homepage:
Church + Organization

Plan Your Visit:
Church + PostalAddress + GeoCoordinates

Event page:
```

Event

Sermon page:

VideoObject

Live service:

VideoObject + BroadcastEvent

Store product:

Product + Offer

Article/news:

Article

For livestreams, Google documents `BroadcastEvent` as a mechanism that can make qualifying streams eligible for a LIVE badge in Search. ⁴⁶

Next.js can generate `sitemap.xml`, metadata and robots instructions dynamically, making every sermon, event, ministry and product a first-class indexable page rather than content buried inside a JavaScript dashboard. ⁴⁷

The church should also publish Google Business Profile updates for important events and announcements; Google currently supports Business Profile posts for announcements, offers and events displayed through Search and Maps. ⁴⁸

Accessibility and performance

Aim for WCAG 2.2 AA from the first component, not as a cleanup project. W3C's requirements address areas particularly relevant here: keyboard access, visible focus, understandable forms, appropriately sized touch targets and accessible authentication. ⁴⁹

The website should also be designed around measurable real-user performance. Vercel's current Speed Insights product measures performance on deployed applications, while its Web Analytics service can provide visitor analytics without relying on third-party analytics cookies. ⁵⁰

Build roadmap, budget and definition of done

Trying to implement every module simultaneously would increase risk. The better approach is to design the full database and permission model early while releasing capabilities progressively.

Foundation release

Planning estimate: roughly three to five development weeks with an experienced full-stack developer plus design/content participation.

Build:

Foundation scope	Deliverable
Branding/design system	Bull Bay typography, components, colours, image direction
Public website	Home, About, Visit, Ministries, Contact
Content CMS	Pages, announcements and staff publishing
Sermons	Series, video, scripture, speaker and search
Live	YouTube/live experience
Events	Calendar and detail pages
Prayer	Submission and routing
Give	Payment-provider integration
Google/SEO	Metadata, sitemap, structured data
Infrastructure	Next.js, Vercel, Supabase, CI/CD

At this stage Bull Bay would already have a substantially stronger public digital presence.

Church management release

Planning estimate: approximately four to six additional development weeks.

Add:

People → households → membership → groups → attendance → connection cards → baptism → pastoral care → tasks → volunteers → check-ins → registration → admin dashboard → pastor dashboard → communications.

This is the point where the website becomes the church's daily operating platform rather than a marketing site.

Commerce release

Planning estimate: approximately three to four additional development weeks.

Add:

Store → inventory → checkout → orders → pickup/shipping → coupons → refunds → digital products → licenses → customer portal → finance reconciliation.

Implement payment provider adapters rather than hardcoding the application to one gateway.

Advanced ministry release

Add:

Automation journeys → analytics → member portal → PWA capabilities → push notifications → advanced search → sermon transcripts → semantic sermon search → ministry dashboards → digital discipleship tracks.

Supabase's existing support for vectors, scheduled jobs, queues and Edge Functions means these enhancements can sit on the same platform rather than requiring a complete architectural rewrite. ⁵¹

Production operating cost

As of August 2026, Supabase Pro starts at **US\$25/month** and currently includes 100,000 monthly active users, 8 GB database disk per project, 100 GB file storage, 250 GB egress and seven-day daily backup retention. ⁵² Vercel Pro currently starts at **US\$20/month** with included usage credit, although actual bandwidth, compute and observability usage can create additional charges. ⁵³

A realistic core infrastructure starting point is therefore approximately:

Component	Initial planning allowance
Supabase Pro	US\$25/month current base price
Vercel Pro	US\$20/month current base price
Domain	Variable
Transactional email	Variable by provider/volume
WhatsApp/SMS	Variable by provider/volume
Payment processing	Variable percentage/fixed fee
Backups/monitoring	Depending on required retention
YouTube	Use existing distribution presence
Core cloud base before communications/payment fees	about US\$45/month at current entry pricing

Supabase PITR is substantially more expensive than the base Pro plan—its current seven-day retention option is approximately US\$100/month—so it should be adopted when transaction volume and business-continuity requirements justify it rather than assumed as part of the basic \$25 plan. ⁵⁴

The software-development budget is much more dependent on who builds it. The scope described here is **not a small \$500 brochure website**. It is a custom ChMS, CMS, pastoral-care system, ecommerce system and digital-product platform. I would plan it as a real software product with UX design, database architecture, payment integration, security review, testing and staff training.

The product I would actually build

My recommended navigation is:

PUBLIC WEBSITE

Home
Visit
About
Ministries
Sermons
Live
Events
Prayer
Give
Shop
Contact

Sign In

Authenticated members receive:

MY CHURCH

Home
My Household
Events
Groups
Serving
Prayer
Giving
Orders & Downloads
Notifications
Profile

Staff receive:

CHURCH ADMIN

Dashboard
People
Visitors
Membership
Care
Prayer

- Groups
- Ministries
- Services
- Volunteers
- Events
- Attendance
- Communications
- Content
- Giving
- Store
- Reports
- Tasks
- Settings
- Audit

Pastoral staff receive a purpose-built view rather than the entire admin UI:

PASTOR

- Today
- People to Follow Up
- Prayer
- Pastoral Care
- Visitors
- Decisions
- Baptism
- Membership
- Ministry Health
- Sermons
- Calendar
- Tasks
- Reports

Finance gets its own restricted environment:

FINANCE

- Dashboard
- Giving
- Funds
- Campaigns
- Payments
- Store Revenue
- Refunds
- Settlements

Reconciliation
Exports
Reports

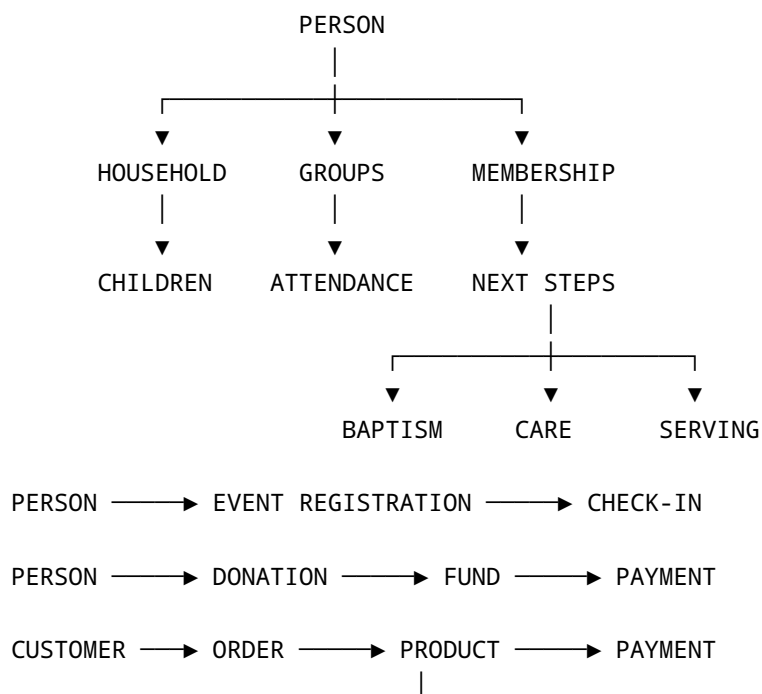
And the commerce backend becomes:

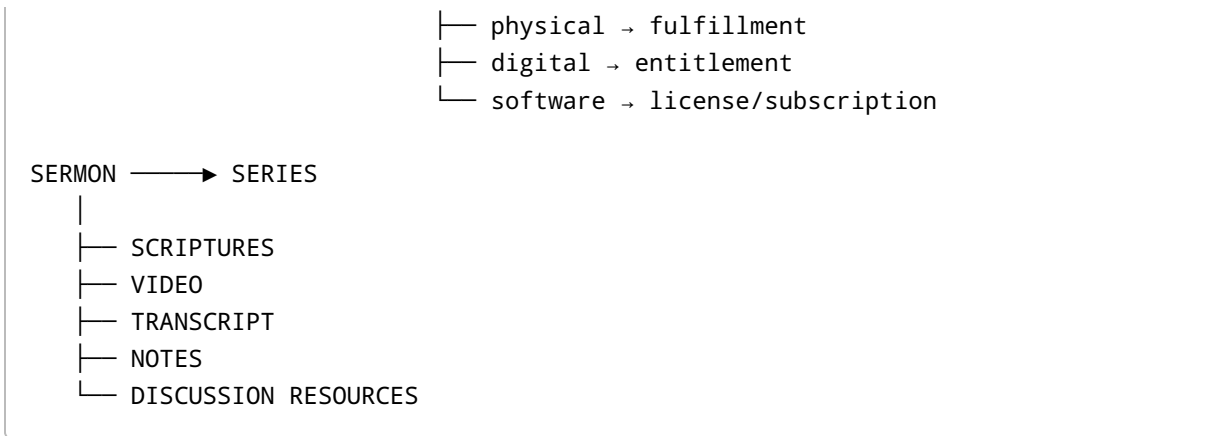
COMMERCE

Products
Categories
Inventory
Orders
Customers
Digital Products
Software
Licenses
Subscriptions
Coupons
Fulfillment
Refunds
Reports

The database relationship at the center

The entire application should revolve around one coherent model:





That architecture is the difference between a website that becomes outdated after two years and a platform that can become central to how Bull Bay operates.

The competitive advantage

Bull Bay does not need to imitate another church website. It can combine the strongest ideas from several categories.

From Elevation and Life.Church: **world-class sermon/live experiences and digital discipleship.** ⁵⁵

From Planning Center and Churchteams: **people, groups, events, volunteers, check-in, registrations and staff automation.** ⁵⁶

From modern ecommerce: **real products, fulfillment and customer accounts.**

From a SaaS product: **software licensing, subscriptions and protected downloads.**

From Supabase: **one PostgreSQL-backed source of truth with authentication, granular database authorization, Storage, server functions, realtime features, jobs and future AI search capability.** ⁵⁷

From Jamaica's payment ecosystem: **local payment acceptance rather than assuming US-only infrastructure,** with WiPay, Lynk and Caribbean acquiring/gateway options to evaluate. ⁵⁸

And from Jamaica's legal environment: **privacy and charity governance engineered into the system instead of added after member data has already accumulated.** ⁵⁹

The end product should therefore be thought of as **Bull Bay Digital Church**: a public website, online church, membership and pastoral-care platform, communications system, event/volunteer system, giving platform, ecommerce store, digital-product marketplace and management dashboard running from one carefully permissioned Supabase-backed architecture.

That is the level of scope capable of making the New Testament Church of God, Bull Bay not merely one of the better-looking church websites in Jamaica, but one of the most operationally sophisticated church digital platforms in the country.

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